Shalini Choudhary

Marketing Manager | Digital Growth, Brand, Content & Customer Experience

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Summary

Digital marketer with 9+ years across agency (GroupM, Ogilvy), in-house (JLL) and education (GUS), with a habit of making brand, search, content and websites earn their keep. At GUS, grew organic traffic 65% YoY with no paid support and traced 9,800 SEO leads to 3,200 applications, a c.£32.9m pipeline (pre-enrolment). Briefed COO-level leadership weekly on what AI answers were doing to organic clicks. Led teams of up to 10 and worked across the Americas, MENA, EMEA and APAC. Then chose to go deeper: a mid-career MS in Marketing Management (University of Leeds), taken to put theory under the instincts, and pressure tested as a CIM x IBM "The Pitch" 2026 finalist.

Work Experience

Senior Manager (Digital Portfolio and Content Strategy) Feb 2022 - Sep 2025

Global University Systems

Integrated organic, content and growth strategy across multiple education brand websites; team of 7-10; executive reporting to the CBO and marketing director

- Grew organic traffic 65% YoY with no paid support, and qualified leads 20% YoY. Lifted lead-to-application conversion 10-12% and cut bounce rate 15-20% on a 50-60K annual lead pipeline (~30% converting).
- Owned the annual organic roadmap, signed off by the COO and Marketing Director. Defended SEO investment by tracing 9,800 Salesforce leads to 3,200 applications: a c.£32.9m pipeline at £10.3K average programme value (pre-enrolment).
- Briefed COO-level leadership weekly on AI answers eroding organic clicks. Reported AI search (GEO/AEO) KPIs (citation share, AI Overview presence, AI share of voice, sentiment, AI referrals) alongside organic performance in Looker Studio executive dashboards.
- Lifted AI citations 15-20% on restructured deep-content pages (tracked in Ahrefs and SEMrush) by front-loading answers and adding FAQ schema. Built entity signals, a hub-and-spoke topical authority model and off-site presence (Reddit, forums, Google Business Profile, education portals).
- Replatformed two legacy education sites onto Drupal with <5% traffic variance and full recovery within a month.
- Led a team of 7-10 (SEO, content, analytics) and set up the cross-functional operating model with dev, brand and analytics. Cut content production time 40% through AI-enabled workflows.
- Built audit templates and playbooks for technical and non-technical audiences, used to train senior stakeholders and C-suite and to coach junior team members.

Marketing Manager (Digital & Integrated Marketing) Nov 2019 - Jan 2022

GroupM (WPP)

Digital marketing and search for global brands including Ford, PepsiCo and Zee5; led 5-6 SEO and marketing specialists

- Owned the technical website analysis and competitor and market analysis for the winning Ford pitch, covering the India market and a 1,200+ page site.
- Grew non-branded organic traffic 20% in 2.5 months for an FMCG client at zero budget, outperforming paid on the same queries on impressions.
- Delivered international SEO across 5 markets in the Americas and MENA, running technical audits (crawling, indexing, Core Web Vitals) and getting fixes shipped through in-house and agency developers, improving indexed pages by 35%.

- Supported 50+ client pitches, 13 of them won, through brand analysis, proposal builds and client presentations, and sized programmes from scope, deliverables and recurring cadences.
- Presented performance data to 20+ clients and built the investment case that secured continued SEO budget when spend was under scrutiny.

Digital Marketing Analyst Feb 2019 - Oct 2019
JLL (Jones Lang LaSalle)
In-house digital marketing and search on a globally indexed domain across EMEA and APAC

- Delivered multi-market SEO across EMEA and APAC on a globally indexed enterprise domain, using competitor and category visibility analysis to reprioritise regional content ahead of schema rollout and technical fixes.
- Rolled out entity-level schema (Organization, FAQ) across a 2,000+ page global site and 100–200-page regional sites, lifting rich results and impressions by 15% in 3 months.
- Built audit templates and playbooks for domestic and global regional sites, shared with the team and used on 100+ pre- and post-launch audits across EMEA and APAC markets.

Marketing Analyst Sep 2016 - Jan 2019
Ogilvy (WPP)
10+ B2B and B2C client accounts | Automotive, FMCG, luxury, healthcare

- Delivered SEO across 10+ client accounts in automotive, luxury, healthcare and e-commerce.
- Delivered international SEO across 40+ markets in the Americas and MENA, including entity-level work on multi-market sites of 150+ pages.
- Prepared and reviewed the SEO sections of client pitch decks.
- Used competitor and category visibility analysis to set priorities for client accounts.

Education

University of Leeds, UK Sep 2025 - Sep 2026
Master of Science (MS) Marketing Management with Advertising

Haridev Joshi University of Journalism 2013 - 2015
Master of Arts (MA) Media Studies

Volunteer

Marketing Executive Dec 2025 - Sep 2026
180 Degrees Consulting Leeds
Advise non-profit and social enterprise clients on brand positioning, audience engagement and communications strategy.